

HISTORY OF ANCIENT PHILOSOPHY II (PHIL 146) NOTES

17/02/2025

Monday

Introduction regarding Plato. General overview of what is to be expected.

21/02/2025

Friday

Meno's Paradox: Knowledge

The centre of discussion in Meno's dialogue: What is virtue? Is virtue acquired by birth or taught?

After getting refuted numerous times by Socrates, instead of trying to pursue the conversation, Meno begins to express his opinions on his dialogue with Socrates, at which point he feels perplexed, as if under a spell by Socrates due to being questioned after everything he puts forward and finding out he doesn't know shit, even though he has given numerous speeches on virtue in front of big audiences.

80d-e ← Meno's Paradox

Meno's Argument:

"You can't search for something you don't know at all, you wouldn't know what to look for."

"Even if you stumble on it, you wouldn't be able to recognize it, you wouldn't be able to identify it as the thing you've been looking for."

Socrates' Response:

"Do you realize what a debater's argument you are bringing up, that a man cannot search either for what he knows or for what he does not know? He cannot search for what he knows—since he knows it, there is no need to search—nor for what he does not know, for he does not know what to look for."

-Either you know what you look for, or you don't know.

-If you know, you can't search (because you already know).

-If you don't know, you can't search (because you don't know what to look for).

^ Search (inquiry), is either unnecessary or impossible.

24/02/2025

Monday

Socrates counters Meno using the “**recollection theory**” ^{81a-e}

It may our first time in this body, yet it isn't our first time in this world. One's soul has been wandering around the underworld since eternity, as they are immortal.

“Our souls have seen all things that is here and in the underworld, there is nothing which it has not learnt, and it is no surprise that it can recollect the things it learned before.”

“What humans call learning is recollection.”

“As the soul is immortal, has been born often, and has seen all things here and in the underworld, there is nothing which it has not learned; so it is in no way surprising that it can recollect the things it knew before, both about virtue and other things. As the whole of nature is akin, and the soul has learned everything, nothing prevents a man, after recalling one thing only—a process men call learning—discovering everything else for himself, if he is brave and does not tire of the search, for searching and learning are, as a whole, recollection.”

The Slave Boy Experiment.

*Refik knows what Socrates knows
Socrates knows what virtue is
What Socrates knows: that virtue is XYZ*

Refik knows that virtue is XYZ ← false

They know different things
(The fallacy of equivocation)

28/02/2025

Friday

Meno's Paradox: How does it connect to the recollection theory?

a priori / a posteriori

The fact that one has to go through an experiment to find out a truth doesn't show the innate nature of that truth (if it is a priori or a posteriori)

Possible Exam Question: *How can one utilise the distinction between a priori and a posteriori to show the fallacy of Meno's Paradox.*

03/03/2025
Monday

- (1) 329c-351d ← discusses with several arguments (The unity of virtues)
(2) 351d-end → intellectualism (which will lead to the unity of virtues) - hedonism

1 - [Homeric Virtues]

- *wisdom
- *temperance
- *justice
- *courage

^ the four cardinal virtues (at the centre of discussion)

Are these virtues all the same (*different names for one single virtue*), or are these names designate different things?

Gold-Face Analogy

If the latter is the case, then all virtues must be unlike each other, both in themselves and in function. **(Face)** ← **Protagoras' claim.**

(a) - Justice and piety have different natures

- "Justice" = "being just" as a property
- "Piety" = "being pious" as a property

virtue (color)
piety(red) justice(blue)

Socrates doesn't agree with this. As he says "When you are being pious, aren't you also just?", and vice versa.

Socrates:

Justice implies piety
Piety implies justice
P ↔ J

C: They are not different properties

(b) - Whatever is done in a *certain way* is done from a *quality*.

- Whatever is done in the *opposite way* is done from the opposite *quality*.

- For each thing that can have an opposite, there is one opposite, not many.

- Foolishness (asophrosune) actions' are opposed to wise actions: one is done from folly, the other from wisdom.

- But foolish actions are also done in a way opposed to temperate actions: one is done from folly, the other from temperance.

07/03/2025

Friday

absent

10/03/2025

Monday

Two positions regarding knowledge in terms of pain and pleasure.

Knowledge in relation to emotions and pleasure/pain.

p782

Socrates asks if emotions control humans rather than knowledge, as in knowledge being a slave of emotion.

He then refutes this and defends knowledge, saying it isn't impotent.

The akrasia problem: The experience of being overcome by pleasure (or pain), and fail to do the best thing when one knows what it is.

akratic person

Socrates believes that there is no such thing as the akrasia problem.

Socrates argues that to understand the akrasia problem, one must first understand what it means to be overcome by pleasure.

Goes into the relation of immediate benefit/harm and the long term effects of such things, smoking
→ gives pleasure → causes cancer

surgery

→ gives pain → results in health

immediate pleasure is not bad, the long term results are bad, thus they are considered bad, vice versa with the other.

If you call the very enjoyment of something bad, it is either because it deprives you of a greater pleasure, or because it brings about more pain than the pleasure it provides.

The conclusion he arrives is this: pleasure and pain are the criteria to consider things as good or bad.

Socrates says there is no such thing as akrasia to commit, thus his argument isn't normative.

Human beings, knowing bad things to be bad, do them all the same, being overcome by pleasure.

Socrates argues that as akrasia is an inconsistent state of mind, it can't exist (as it is illogical to be doing both good and bad thing at the same time).

What appears to be akrasia is the absence of knowledge, as one who truly believes something to be bad wouldn't indulge in it, meaning they don't know it is bad even if they argue that they do.

Socratic intellectualism – self evident truths ← *important part*

Self-evidence and truth are different things, “*I think, therefore I am*” ← this statement may be true, yet it isn’t self evident as thinking does not directly relate to existence, without proper explanation it wouldn’t be evident.

14/03/2025

Friday

Socratic Intellectualism

VIRTUE IS KNOWLEDGE

HOW IS ALL THIS RELATED TO THE DISCUSSION ABOUT COURAGE AND THE UNITY OF VIRTUE

Knowledge runs a person, so do the virtues.

17/03/2025

Monday

PHAEDO for further reading: <https://iep.utm.edu/phaedo/>

Death of Socrates

Recollection Theory (slave boy)

Plato is not an empiricist

Recollection difference between similar and different things (p64)

You cannot perceive similarity without perceiving difference.

Resemblance

similarity ↔ difference

The Equal itself

perceptible equals(things)

the equal itself

the equals themselves

^

deficiently equal

Cambridge change – change in relation to something else while the subject itself doesn't undergo any change – Plato^{??} thinks this is real change

relational properties

the two stick example and the belonging of the quality of equality, what does the relation of equality belong to?

Things change their properties but properties themselves do not change

21/03/2025

Friday

Class on oligarchies of ancient greece. Go figure.

24/03/2025

Monday

Had a stomach ache, couldn't attend class.

28/03/2025

Friday

My stomach got worse, couldn't attend again.

31/03/2025

Monday

Religious Holiday

04/04/2025

Friday

Religious Holiday (extended for reasons unbeknownst to mankind)

07/04/2025
Monday

Fucking finally.

Plato is not an empiricist.

Equal/sensible/perceptible things are deficiently equal.

Deficient equality → Not in mathematical sense.

Cambridge change – Cambridge properties
→ Plato thinks this is *real* change.

The equal itself is the relation of equality itself.
→ The red and the equal.

Deficiency of the perception of things

→ The intellectual grasp is never given in perception, the knowledge of an object is not given in this life, perception itself starts in this life.

There is a need for prior knowledge.

No object displays its perfect form in perception.

If that is **a prior knowledge**, then the life we learn it in must be **a prior life**. *Ultimately this is the theory of recollection.*

One can **never** grasp **a perfect object in perception**, *as the perfect isn't given in this life, one must have prior knowledge for it.*

14/04/2025
Monday

Plato is not an empiricist, he has an idea of perception.

-We have knowledge of the Forms. **Ex:** *the Equal itself*.

→ This knowledge is not to be explained as given to us in perception because

a) In so far as things given to us in perception fall short of being the corresponding Form, *the knowledge of Forms is different than the perception of sensible things.*

b) Consequently, the object of the *knowledge of Forms* is **not given** (it is not to be found) in **perception**.

c) Consequently, **this knowledge** is **not originated in perception**.

PLATO IS NOT AN EMPIRICIST

Socrates was looking a theory of causes. (Why are thing the way they are?)

The distinction between **Tallness** and **tallness-share**

There is the situation of conflicting properties.

The first version of his theory was naive and simple.

Moral qualities are external and objective qualities that are had by things, just as height, size, weight.

If you can find out a way of explaining these things, then you can apply the same principle to moral qualities.

This is the **naïve** version of his theory.

Socrates was **looking for** when he first started studying natural philosophy was the cause of **why things are the way they are**.

The natural philosophy disappointed him.

Socrates' renounced that the idea of explaining properties of things in terms of physical features they have.

For you to be taller than something else you need to have the quality of tallness.

Length encodes both, since anything is taller and shorter at the same time.

Therefore length, the physical determinate, cannot tell whether something is tall or short.

Physically, everything is everything at the same time. (*The example of shortness and the tallness occurring at the same time.*)

As physical things cannot separate qualities, the need for forms arises.

21/04/2025

Monday

Plato tries to find an explanation as to why reality is the way it is. ← The centre of his attention

He finds the forms in order to explain reality.

p88

Properties themselves never admit the opposite property.

Even though the object itself admits both.

When Phaedo's tallness overcomes Simmias' shortness, shortness approaches Simmias.

This is because his tallness leaves and his shortness comes out in to the front.

When Simmias is taller than Socrates, this tallness comes out in front and his shortness leaves.

^ Here the approach and leaving of tallness and shortness aren't in literal sense, but is explained like so for easier understanding.

For any physical thing these events happen simultaneously, this is the reason as to why things are tall and short at the same time.

Since the opposing events (tallness and shortness approaching and leaving) happen at the same time, something is both tall and short at the same time.

+Is Simmias tall?

-Yes, and at the same time No.

According to Plato, the **physical reality violates the principal of no contradiction**.

Since Tallness and Shortness (the Forms themselves) comply with the principles of truths unlike the physical reality, they are the only way to obtain truth and knowledge.

This all comes from Heraclitus as Plato thinks constant change is real. He appeals to Heraclitus for physical reality.

He also appeals to Parmenides for knowledge.

Plato's additions to his first version of the theory of forms.

p89

HOT **COLD**

FIRE **SNOW**

Against cold fire behaves the same way as hot behaves, against hot, snow behaves the same way the cold behaves. Even if **these are not opposing properties** they still behave as if their necessary properties are opposed to each other.

Not only the Forms remain to be what they are but there are also *certain things*, different from the **FORMS**, always necessarily retaining the character_(feature/property) they have through Forms.

Fire behaves against cold the way hot behaves against cold because fire always necessarily retains property it has through the Forms. Since fire has the property of hot it behaves like hot against cold. They are necessarily tied to each other.

ODD **EVEN**

THREE **TWO**

Not only the opposite Forms do not admit each others approach but also there are some other things that do not admit the onset of opposites.

These second kind of things, they compel whatever they occupy not only to contain their own Form, but also another Form which is opposite to another Form.

- What the Form three occupies must not only be three but also Odd (which is opposite to Even)

- "Even" will never come to "Three"

- "Three" has no share in "Even"

* * * Three is uneven.

It is the presence of the intermediate element which makes something a certain property of something.

This regarding life →

Soul – Only those things which have a soul are alive. Soul brings along (to the things that it occupies) life.

Just like **fire cannot admit cold, soul cannot admit death**.

Soul is deathless. It is necessarily attached to life just as number three is attached to Odd.

25/04/2025

Friday

Republic, V, 474b-480c ← Read

KNOWLEDGE	OPINION
(<i>episteme</i>)	(<i>doxa</i>)

Forms are one over many

The understanding of Beautiful itself and beauty.

Lovers of sight and sounds only believe in the existence of mediums and **NOT** in Forms.

They only believe what they see. (*See as in all senses, not just sight*)

↓

They never believe in the Beautiful itself.

Lovers of sight → only “opine”	(<i>as in opinion, they only have opinions</i>)
Philosophers → know	(<i>as in episteme, they have knowledge</i>)

For each epistemic state, there exists a corresponding object with a corresponding ontological status.

When you say someone has knowledge, this person always has knowledge of something.

Knowledge is always of something existent.

Knowledge is if you know something (it is existent [true]) → Parmenidean sense

Like Parmenides, if something is non-existent, you can't know it (*you cannot know a falsity, you can't know 2+2=5*)

<u>Knowledge</u>	<u>Ignorance</u>
existent (truth)	no object to know

Plato: Knowledge is set-over what-is.
Ignorance is set-over what-is-not.

<u>Knowledge</u>	<u>Opinion</u>	<u>Ignorance</u>
<i>what-is</i>	<i>what-is</i>	<i>what-is-not</i>
	<i>what-is-not</i>	
	(both included)	

But how to prove that there is an intermediate state of being?

By investigating into the nature of things (*knowledge, ignorance*) one can understand what it is.

Now we need to investigate if there is an epistemic state between knowledge and ignorance.

Having different objects implies having different senses.

Knowledge

Opinion

Simmias is both tall and short



Your answer can't go beyond opinion
as Simmias is an object of this kind.
Object itself compels its corresponding
epistemic state.



This can be explained on the basis of
object, not the other way around, it the object
that determines what state you are in.

Ignorance

27/04/2025

Sunday

Video Material:

Plato Republic 05: The Theory of Tripartition by Katja Maria Vogt: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=h0DsTl2We0E>

The view that soul has three parts: Reason, Spirit, (Competitive?) Desire

There is a distinction between qualified and unqualified desire.

Hunger and thirst being the best examples.

Someone can be thirsty in an unqualified way (cold drink, coffee) They want a drink, but don't know what they want to drink.

Same with hunger. Or anything else.

Plato Republic 06: The Lovers of Sights and Sounds by Katja Maria Vogt: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WWG9gu7LASy>

09/05/2025

Friday

Aristotle: Categories

- a) My table is white. → “being-in”
- b) The colour of my table is white.
- c) Socrates is a human being. → “said-of” ← predicating the property TO Socrates ← saying something essential (the subject cannot be without it) about the subject, you are predicating something essential about the subject

Aristotle distinguishes two kinds of predication:

1) (In which we say) Something of another thing

* “said-of” predication = ~ essential predication > predicating a property that the subject cannot fail to have
“is”

2) (In which we say) Something is in another thing

* being-in” predication = ~ accidental predication > subject can be without it
“has”

Removing the being-in → The table won’t lose anything of being a table, it will just lose the property of being white, it could be any other colour.

Importance of the subject → ontological implications

Difference in metaphysics

a) and **b)** do not speak the same metaphysics

b) and **c)** are of the same metaphysics

“being-in”

1) *Ontological Dependence:*

A is ontologically dependent on B, **iff** A cannot exist without B existing.

this particular bit of whiteness in the table could have belonged to another subject, but as long as it belongs to my table it is ontologically dependent to my table. It isn’t a necessary property of my table.

2) No existence without a subject (for the properties which are to be found in other things).

This particular bit of color in my table is of the species white, **but what is in my table isn’t the general white.**

3) What is ontologically dependent is not the **color** “whiteness”.

The colour white itself is in my table, but not in the same particular way the colour white is.

The colour white is related to being in the table without being ontologically dependent on it.

If you destroy the table you will destroy its particular whiteness, but nothing will happen to colour white itself.

4) “being-in” ~ “being **in** (→ spatial) something”

“being-in” relation is not to be confused with “being in somewhere”, it is not spatial.

It’s not a **part-whole** relation either. We don’t mean to say that whiteness is a part of my table as its legs are.

Certain things have an ontological priority over other things. → They need a subject to exist. B has an ontological priority over A, as A depends on B to exist.

Aristotle calls ontologically prior things “substances” → *they act as the subject of certain properties.*

There also are the “non-substances” → *they are ontologically dependent, they need subjects to exist in.*

This is the first major division in Aristotle’s ontology, substances in one hand and non-substances in the other hand.

12/05/2025
Monday

Aristotle's substances:

Substances are one of the (and the first) categories of Aristotle's 10 categories.

Substances are the bottom rock realities. They are structured on the variations of relations of predication between the ultimate subjects (substances) and everything else that can be predicated of substances.

Substances are particular things like Socrates. The very particular human being who lived in Athens during the designated time.

These particular things are substances, this particular table, this particular bottle, this particular horse, this particular human being.

Aristotle calls such things not only substances but he calls them **primary substances**. *Primary substances are particular things serving as ultimate subjects of predication for non-substance things.*

Reality therefore is built and structured on these primary substances and on their ontological role as subjects. We owe reality to these particulars that act as subjects. They act as subjects for other things that fall under the non-substance categories. Colour for instance, there is no color without a subject, there is no quantity without a subject, these things exist because subjects exist.

Non-substances are also real and exist as substances do.

being-in

SUBSTANCE

Substance

NON-SUBSTANCE

All the other categories, i.e. quality, quantity etc.

The division is on the basis of **being-in relation**.

When you use the being-in relation to analyse reality, your categories will be substances and non-substances.

Entities between which a being-in relation holds are substances and non-substances.

Socrates is white.

What the sentence says (ontologically): *Whiteness is in Socrates.*

The **in** here doesn't mean that whiteness is a part of Socrates physically. The word "*in*" here isn't the physical sense.

The strict translation of this sentence would be as following: *There is this particular human being called "Socrates" which has a patch of color white in it.*

As a metaphysician when you hear a sentence like the former, the latter is what you hear.

This sentence contains both set-of relations and being-in relations. You need to see where they are and which entities are put in connection.

Before this, what are the entities involved in this sentence?

We identify the entities this sentence holds, and then see the kind of relation holding between these entities.

- 1) The **particular** human being called “Socrates”
- 2) The **kind** of being that Socrates is, namely a human being.
- 3) The **particular** patch of whiteness which is said to be in this **particular** human being Socrates.
- 4) The **kind** of color that this **particular** patch of white **is**, namely whiteness. (*kind goes with is*, will be discussed later)
- 5) The **kind** of things that the whiteness in **4 is**, namely a color.

(>Add this: The diagram regarding the relations between color white particular white Socrates.
Page -6)

Ultimately the particular patch of whiteness is in Socrates and it carries is said-of relations with it.

Said-of relations

Socrates belongs to the class of human beings. Socrates cannot fail to belong to the class of human beings.

- (1) “human being” is **said of** Socrates. (*this establishes a set of relations between the class and the particular*)

Socrates belongs to the class of “human beings” in the sense that he cannot fail to belong to this class.

Socrates admits the definition of human being. Human being can be truly predicated of Socrates.

- (2) the color white is **said of** the particular patch of whiteness which is **in** Socrates.

- (3) “color” is **said of** whiteness, an instance of which is **in** Socrates.

- (3¹) “color” is **said of** the particular patch of whiteness.

	said-of	
<u>UNIVERSALS</u>	→	<u>PARTICULARS</u>

Universals are a set of particulars, non-substances are parts⁷ of substances.

The **said-of** relation *divides things into universals and particulars*.

The **being-in** relation *divides things into substances and non-substances*.

Theory of Forms is too simple to capture the analysis given here. Plato draws a line straight from color to Socrates, Aristotle gives the detailed explanation. The connection is not that straightforward and simple. This is Aristotle solution to certain problems of Plato’s theory of Forms.

All these entities substances, universals, particulars, non-substances, they are REAL, they have to be real because when you say Socrates is white, this is true, which means that this is the reality, therefore the logic goes that reality has to be composed of real components, if “Socrates is white.” is the reality, its components also have to be real. Even if they are all real they don’t exist in the

same way. Substances have an ontological priority compared to other realities, they depends on substances for existence. Colours, quantities, qualities (non-substances) are real, but in their own way. Socrates, table, dog (substances) are all real in their own ways.

		BEING-IN	
		→	→
		<u>SUBSTANCES</u>	<u>NON-SUBSTANCES</u>
SAID-OF	→ <u>UNIVERSALS</u> :	human being	color white
	→	<i>secondary substances</i>	
	→ <u>PARTICULARS</u> :	Socrates	a particular patch of
whiteness	→	<i>primary substances</i>	

14/05/2025

Wednesday

The idea behind the Aristotelian theory of categories is the structural analysis of sentences.

Non-substances aren't any less real than substances. They are not a-symmetrical though, as the existence of non-substances depend on the substances.

Not only Socrates' particular patch of whiteness depend on Socrates, the general colour of white and its existence also depends on **things** like Socrates, ***if there weren't any substances there wouldn't be any non-substances.***

Primary substances are the bottom rock of reality and they act as the ultimate subjects of everything else.

Therefore the ontological relation between the non-substance and substances is a-symmetrical in this sense.

Animal – human being → universals for Socrates.

A said-of relation is more complicated than a being-in relation.

Socrates' existence depends on its being (said-of) a human being. You can think of it as Socrates parenthesis, if you dissipate Socrates' existence you will lose Socrates, there will be no more Socrates.

According to Aristotle, the species of human beings (Homo Sapiens) wouldn't exist if there were no human beings.

This is a major difference between him and Plato as for Plato even if there were no human beings in the universe there were still be the Form of Human Being. Even if there were no red things there were still be the Form of Red.

Aristotle thinks that there would be no such thing as a human being if there were no such thing as a Socrates.

There is a sense in which things like Socrates depend on the corresponding universal things and there is an example of universals depending on particular things like Socrates.

This particular Socrates depends on being a human being, he is related as a particular to humanness, but it doesn't work the same way for the inverse relation, as the existence of the human species

doesn't depend on this particular Socrates. People are born, people die, the species continues. Humanness doesn't depend on any **particular** thing.

The very particular depends on the universal for its existence, the universal itself doesn't depend on any one particular for its existence but depends on the collection of the particulars.

We go back to the said-of relation:

Aristotle's formula of division for said-of is:

+What is said-of a subject is a universal and a particular is what is not said-of a subject.

Socrates itself is never said of another thing to classify it as a certain thing. (*It is not predicable. You can't say my table has a particular patch of Socrates.*)

Those things that are not said-of anything else are particulars.
Anything that is said-of another thing is a universal.

The particular whiteness that belongs to Socrates doesn't behave like universal whiteness, it behaves like Socrates.

The being-in relation:

What the being-in relation does is dividing the same set created by the said-of relation from a different angle.

It divides the same set of things into substances and non-substances.

Aristotelian definition of substances:

*** What can *never* be in a subject is a substance, and what can be in a subject is a non-substance.**

(>Now to improve the table: *check your notes. Page: -6*)

***Whatever is ontologically dependent on another thing is in a being-in relation with its subjects, because it cannot exist without the subject (like the whiteness of my t-shirt, if my t-shirt doesn't exist, the whiteness of it doesn't exist.).**

White can act as a predicate of Socrates:
Socrates is white.

Socrates can't act as a predicate of white (or anything else for that matter):
White is Socrates.

The ontologically dependent item can be a predicate of the thing of which it depends. ← being-in relation

this doesn't

work in the case of said-of relations
Humanness is Socrates. ← This doesn't work.

Secondary Substances: He calls those things secondary substances because they reveal the whatness of a primary substance.

They are substances because they tell the whatness of the primary substances.

Then again, why aren't whiteness and the likes are not secondary substances? Because they aren't substances. (Refik moment lmao)

They are **in** primary substances, which makes them non-substances.

Reality is structured in the subjecthood of primary substances (everything is related and predicated to these things),

The problem of naked being (Plato's) in relation to secondary substances: → There wouldn't be any subject for Socrates to be in if it wasn't a human being. Not the same deal with colors.

*Socrates can be without color, Socrates **can't be** without **humanness**.* Socrates happened to be white, he didn't happen to be a human being. There is no way for Socrates to exist without being a human being.

There is no accidental relation between Socrates and humanness as such a thing cannot exist.

* → this is related to Plato's naked beings because if they were in Socrates, Socrates would first have to be a naked being.

This is Aristotle's solution to the naked being problem in Plato, universals are said-of subjects, but they are not in the subjects.

Difference of the subjects on the upper right corner of the table.

The said-of relation concerns the particular whiteness, the being-in relation concerns Socrates.

Relation of behaving as a predicate or a subject.

Plato's theory of Forms doesn't make a difference between mechanical predication and accidental predication.

Aristotle thinks that there should be a difference. *Being a human being for Socrates and being white for Socrates shouldn't be the same thing, there should be a difference.*

Socrates is white because something **IN** Socrates is white, not like in the case of Socrates being a human being. ← Aristotle's solution to the first problem.

Universal substances are not **in** primary substances. ← Aristotle's solution to the second problem (naked being)

16/05/2025

Friday

Aristotle philosophy of nature → **De Anima** ← the text

Psychology but **not** in the modern sense.

psyche / soul / ensouled

→ psyche in Greek would translate to “*Can*” (as in life) in Turkish

Things have a soul and ensouled things are things which have a psyche.

Aristotle says that the **ensouled things** are the most **perfect examples** of things he understands as **substance**.

Greatest part of Aristotle's texts are on biology.

Psychology in the Aristotelian sense is the study of **substance-hood**. This isn't the case in the modern sense.

De Anima II

In this book he wants to **determine what soul is** and what account of it best applies to **all souls**. The opening lines of the book suggest that there are multiple kinds of souls for Aristotle.

Ensouled → alive, has soul.

Aristotle thinks that plants, animals, humans and Gods are all living beings because they are ensouled.

But they have different kinds of psyche. There are different kinds of psyche in nature.

Scala naturae

plants

animals
human beings

God(s)

Plants and Gods are simple in terms of living beings.

Plants are at the bottom level, Gods is at the top.

Plants are as simple as Gods and vice versa.

Animals are more complicated compared to them.

There are certain animals that are called dualizers, they are animals but they behave like plants (*Bob l'éponge*).

The scale is continuous, there isn't a direct jump.

There also are dualizers between animals/humans and Gods.

Complex forms of life causes problems that need solving. Plants and Gods do not have problems to solve. ← this is the reason humans need ethics, politics, etc.

Different kinds of souls:

Human beings have all the kinds of souls in the human way. This is the reason of complexity.

Animals have the kind of soul that themselves and the plants have.

Plants and Gods each only have their own kind of soul.

Souls

Human soul is a complex of plurality of souls.

Animal soul is a simple version of it, but it is still complex.

Plants and Gods are simple.

“By life I understand self-nourishment, growth and decay.” → *this is not a definition as this doesn't apply to Gods.*

Gods are not a part of nature, they are alive but they aren't a natural thing. (>Relate this to the above sentence.)

The most important thing about Aristotle's psychology as it makes all the difference between him and Plato and following philosophers.

life – body

He says that what is alive in nature is a body.

For Aristotle, being alive is a property of a body, for Plato it is a property of the soul.

Life is what a body is capable of doing.

Life is a praxis because it is all these actions that a living body can do.

Plants act, animals act, humans act.

Substance

Three senses of substance:

(1) – Matter

(2) – Form

(3) – Compound of Matter and Form ← be really careful about this → **(matter+form)** ← this is **NOT** a compound.

Bodies (with the property of being alive) are the compounds of Matter and Form.

Matter: Is substance in the sense that it is the subject which receives the Form. It is the subject of which the Form is predicated.

There is no Matter without Form. Matter is not something that you can define without taking Form into account.

There is no unFormed matter in nature.

If you remove Form from matter, what would remain is an indeterminate thing, the naked being, no matter alone is a particular determinate thing.

When you remove Form from matter, matter is no longer a **this-something**.

21/05/2025
Wednesday

De Anima:

3 Senses of substance

The compound of matter and form again.

In nature there is no body without life.

Every body is a living body.

“The sort that is alive”

A body is a matter which is designed for life. It's always already designed for life.

A matter which is designed in a way to engage in life actions (self-nourishment, growth, decay).

A body is an organized body (in the sense of having organs, limbs).

It has organs as instruments for life activities. It is capable of acting in this way.

Life is not separable from body as matter.

Life is not something you can blow into matter to make it alive from outside.

You cannot put life into a matter to make it alive.

No body is without life.

The corpse of a dead person is not a body.

The corpse is not the same matter as the body when it was **alive**.

A corpse would never be a matter for a living thing. You cannot bring a matter into life again.

When life leaves the body what remains is not the same matter when it was alive.

The body of a person alive and the body of the same person when dead is not the same matter.

The matter of a corpse is not a body.

The matter prior was organised in a way to live, this is not what you have with a corpse.

Aristotle: *“The soul must be a substance as the Form of a natural body that is potentially alive. The soul will be the actuality of this specific sort of body.”*

1) The soul is the Form of a natural body. But this body is what is potentially alive. (Not the external shape)

2) The soul is the actuality of this specific kind of body.

The soul is the actuality of a body which is potentially alive.

A body is a matter which **can** live. (Which can engage itself in life actions)

Soul is the actuality of this body. Soul is the **realization** of this potentiality.

Soul is the putting in action of this potentiality the body has for life.

The soul is nothing other than the actualization the body has for life.

The soul is nothing other than the body in action.

Potentiality

Actuality

→ the crucial terms to be understood.

Actuality is to be understood in two senses:

An example Aristotle gives: “*Actuality is spoken of in two ways, one corresponding to the state of knowing, and the other to attending to what one knows.*”

(This is only an example regarding knowledge, this distinction holds for several other things.)

I know how to ride a bike → the actual knowledge (the know-how)

Although it is a fact that I know how to ride a bike, my knowledge of riding a bike is only a potentiality at the moment.

When I start riding my bike to go somewhere, what I do is to actualize the knowledge I have of riding my bike.

I do actually know how to ride a bike → I do actually ride a bike.

[$\sim$ → corresponds to]

Actuality₁ $\sim$ potentiality

Actuality₂ $\sim$ actualization of Actuality₁($\sim$ potentiality)

In this picture there still is another potentiality:

Even before I obtained (for this example) the knowledge as to how to ride a bike, I was still a potential rider.

Even before I learned how to ride a bike, I was still a potential rider.

I was still the kind of thing which can learn how to ride a bike, a stone for instance cannot learn how to learn a bike, it has no potentiality, I do.

There is a potentiality which precedes actuality₁ and actuality₂:

Potentiality₁

Actuality₁ $\sim$ Potentiality₂

Actuality₂ $\sim$ actualization of Actuality₁

I can₁ and I can₂ not speak Italian. (*In the sense that I am capable of learning and speaking Italian. [the potentiality of speaking Italian.]*)

This is not a contradiction as I do not speak about the same potentialities.

I can not actually speak Italian, but I can potentially speak Italian.

Aristotle’s ultimate and official definition for soul: “*The soul is the first actuality of a natural body that is potentially alive.*” (Actuality₁)

The body is in the definition of soul, which means that Aristotle defines soul in terms of body.

In the Aristotelian picture soul is not a substance, it is nothing other than how a body is. Soul is just a way of being actual in a body.

If there is no body, no soul. Soul is nothing other than how a body is.

There is no dualism in the Aristotelian picture, there is no way that you can separate body and soul as soul is nothing other than how a body is.

Refik: *For a living being, its soul is its being actually capable of engaging in life activities.*

The matter that the body is, is always a body organized for a soul.

Potentiality₁ = the body

Actuality₁ $\sim$ Potentiality₂ = the soul

Actuality₂ $\sim$ actualization of Actuality₁

Do not think in temporal terms. There is no temporality involved here, the relation between these things do not happen in time in a successive way.

A living body is always and only a living body. It only is a living matter.

Aristotle: “*The actuality and what is actualized **are fully one.***”

There aren't two things here, we only have one thing, there is only living body and its living is its soul.

The potentiality a natural body has for life is already definitive. Life is a part of its definition.

Body as a matter is matter destined to live a certain kind of life, the kind of life that is actualized **as (not by)** its soul.

A matter in nature for a living being is always a matter for a certain life.

Life is always in nature a certain kind of life, and soul is always a certain kind of animals soul.

A whale is a matter that is designed for whale life. The only kind of life an animal can live is the life its body is designed for.

Birds do not fly because they have wings, they have wings because they are flying kind of animals. The body is organized in a way to match the kind of life it is designed for.

Wings would be pointless for spiders because their life is not a flying life.

There is no life without being a certain specific kind of life, there is no soul without being a certain specific kind of soul.

Refik: The soul of a spider is its being **actually**₁ ready to **act**₂ as a spider, i.e. to engage in actions typical of a spiders life.

Zoe and Bios (in Greek)

Bios is the life plan, it is composed of the actions an animal can perform.

23/05/2025

Friday

>To be added